

Skidmore College, Saratoga Springs, NY

Anticipated graduation May 2026

Bachelor of Arts in honors Integrative Biology, Minor: Media and film studies

GPA: 3.6

Relevant Coursework: immunology, cellular and molecular biology, biostatistics, disease ecology and evolution, principles of chemistry, genetics, biotech revolution

Honors and Awards: Dean's List Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Faculty Student Summer Research Program Summer 2024 \$4000 Award, Biology See Beyond 2026 \$6000 Award, Student Opportunity Fund 2025 \$700 Award, Abroad photography competition winner, Golden acorn Award 2025 and 2026

School for International Training Madagascar, Indonesian Borneo, Cape Town

August 2025 - December 2025

Studied tropical biodiversity and community based, sustainable, conservation practices while immersed in Malagasy and Indonesian culture

Research Experience

Collaborative Research, Amphibian Disease Ecology Lab, Skidmore College, Saratoga Springs, NY

January 2024- Present

Principal Investigator: Emily Le Sage, PhD.

Explored the effects of salinity and Chytridiomycosis infection on anuran immunology, cytokine proliferation, and AMP production

- Literature review, experimental design, planning, and investigating fungal metabolite impact on cytokine immune response in an anuran epithelial cell line
- DNA extraction, qPCR, cell maintenance, culturing *Batrachochytrium dendrobatidis*, and growth inhibition assays in a BSL 2 Lab with Sterile Technique
- Optimization of laboratory protocols to increase efficiency and reduce waste when investigating infectious disease loads in specimens swabbed in the field
- Nocturnal fieldwork in dense forest environments, recording morphometric data, and swabbing various species of amphibians often in rainy conditions

Independent research, Laboratory of Integrative and Comparative Herpetology

May 2024 - July 2024

Principal Investigator: Robert Espinoza, PhD, SSAR DEI committee chair

Evaluated physiology of understudied New Caledonian, *Mniarogekko Chahoa*, through specimens rescued by US FWS

- Performed herpetology based literature review in collaboration with partners at California State University, Northridge for grants and abstracts
- Conducted research identifying and capturing invasive Californian herpetofauna including *Gekko* sp. in urban environments via trapping and lizard noose

Collaborative Research, Circadian Rhythm laboratory, Skidmore College, Saratoga Springs, NY

January 2023 - May 2023

Principal Investigator: Bernard Possidente, PhD.

Examined the effects of *Mus musculus* circadian rhythm on alcoholism

- Consistent data collection and statistical analysis to evaluate true chronotypes under constant dark conditions, using ClockLab, Excel, and SAS
- Ensured quality care and husbandry for 50 mice through monitoring, observing feeding habits, and timely feedings aligned with their circadian rhythms

Independent Research, biodiversity assessment for Friends of Nature, People, and Forests in Borneo, Indonesia

October 2025 - December 2025

Mentors: Dr. Pak Bayu, DVM and Petrus Basuki Budi Santoso, program manager

Comparative assessment of herpetofaunal biodiversity across several environments and reforested areas

- Assessed biodiversity in: mined areas, palm oil farms, swamp, old growth forest, recently burned areas, and reforested areas
 - Built four weather proof large funnel traps with dual axis 16m drift fences out of scrap materials in the jungle
 - Used GPS to create transects in 5 ecosystems, identified rare herpetofauna, recorded environmental data and statistical analysis using SAS
 - Collaboration with Indonesian foresters to contextualize results and attendance of environmental cultural festival to more deeply understand local customs
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Presentations

Thompson, R. "Understanding the Fungus Among us: Exploring Salt's Effect on Amphibian Disease Chytridiomycosis" Oral Presentation, The society for Integrative and Comparative Biology (SICB), Portland Convention Center, January 2026

Feng, Y., & Thompson, R. "Mouse Chronotype Does Not Predict Alcohol Consumption" Poster Presentation, Annual NEURON Conference, Quinnipiac University, April 2023

Thompson, R. "Impacts of Salt on Amphibian Disease" Poster presentation, Saratoga Sustainability Fair, April 2025

Lubitz, J., & Thompson, R. "Regulation of Antimicrobial Peptide Synthesis in Response to Bd Infection" Poster Presentation, Skidmore College Academic Festival, July 2024

Zajac, E., & Thompson, R. "Impacts of Salt on Amphibian Disease" Poster presentation, Skidmore College Academic Festival, July 2024

Professional Experience

Veterinary Assistant, ShotVet, Orlando, FL

May 2025 -August 2025

- Safely restraining Canines and Felines during treatment, rolling for veins, and heartworm testing

- Followed sterile procedures to prepare vaccines and other medical equipment in a high stakes, fast paced environment
- Translated immunological concepts to clients including prevalence of parasitic infections, and background on why certain vaccinations are state mandated

Zookeeper, Orianne Center for Indigo Snake Conservation: affiliated with AZA accredited Central Florida Zoo

June 2025 -August 2025

- Ensured high quality of life for over 200 threatened *Drymarchon Couperi* by providing enrichment, feeding, and conducting health checks
- Husbandry and enclosure maintenance in an AZA accredited facility, complying with AZA standards and intensive protocol
- Worked closely with a veterinarian to provide medical treatment for snakes infected with *Ophidiomyces* (snake fungal disease) and *Cryptosporidium*
- Prevented disease breakouts across five different levels of biosecurity through following intensive biosafety protocol and wearing proper PPE
- Monitored egg incubation temperature in several incubators and recorded morphometric data on hatchlings

Lead teaching instructor, Amphibian Foundation, Atlanta, GA

May 2023 - August 2023, Winter 2023, Winter 2024

- Presented 10 unique lectures on the biology of reptiles and amphibians and brought students into the field to safely search for local reptiles and amphibians
- Provided proper care and husbandry to a 20+ exotic herpetofauna including poison dart frogs and cuban false chameleons

Documentary filmmaker, Moore Documentary Studies Collaborative, Saratoga, NY

January 2023 -Present

- Creating meaningful, collaborative documentaries through peer mentoring, project consultation, and providing training for advanced filmmaking equipment
- Leveraged documentary skillset and public outreach to amplify voices of marginalized communities by distributing their stories in an accessible format
- Collaboratively produced 20+ event documentation, personalized interviews, Editing and post-production services for a variety of community partners
- Proficiency in advanced equipment such as: Canon C200, kit lighting, Zoom recorders, and gimbals
- Involvement in interview and selection process of future Skidmore media and film professors

Certifications

CITI Trainings: biosafety Level 1 and 2, working with amphibians in research settings, wildlife research - students working with animals

Expires February 2027

Master Herpetologist certification, Facilitated by the Amphibian foundation

Issued May 2023

Venomous animal handling certification, Facilitated by the Rattlesnake Conservatory

Issued December 2024

Skills

Laboratory: Aseptic technique, Sterile Technique, DNA Extraction, qPCR, Spectrophotometer, Precision Micropipetting, Centrifuge, Titration, Serial Dilution, Nanodrop, Hemacetomator, Confocal Microscopy, Fluorescent Microscopy, Growth Inhibition Assays, Culturing Animal and Fungal Cells, Working in Biosecurity Cabinet, Undergone Advanced Lab Safety and Waste Disposal Safety Training (course included: interpreting SDS, reading NFPA Hazard Diamond, Proper Spill Procedure, Safe Chemical Storage, Proper Hazardous Waste Disposal, etc.), Wet Specimen Preparation and Maintenance

Software: Microsoft suite and Excel proficiency, SAS, Clocklab, Adobe Creative Suite, InkStitch, Plural Eyes

Experience speaking Spanish, French, and Indonesian Bahasa

Proficiency in Adobe Creative Suite software, 8 years of experience creating digital media projects

Puppeting, advanced velocity keyframing with easy ease in graph editor, rotoscoping, ultra keying (greenscreen), compositing, and complicated effect editing in Adobe After Effects, Color correction, synchronizing audio, video editing, and polishing in Adobe Premiere, Experience using Photoshop and Adobe Illustrator for graphic design, masking, and vector editing

Proficiency in Advanced filmmaking equipment, Independent filmmaking and photography

experience with netflix-standard cameras such as the Canon C200 skilled with DSLRs, appropriate lens use and selection, 3 point lighting with C-stands, cross lighting, and general experience in professional lighting, managing multiple audio sources through a zoom recorder such as: boom mics, lav mics, and shotgun mics, used rigs such as dollies, shoulder mounts, track sliders, and DJI Ronin gimbals, experience shooting in studio settings, outdoors, wildlife photography, portraiture, event documentation, interviews, dance performances, and managing two camera shoots on my own

Awards and Film Festivals

Golden Acorn Award, photography, *Mini Worlds*, May 2025

Refractions Film Festival, Documentary, *Valuable Venom*, April 2025

Society for the Study of Reptiles and Amphibians Selected Film, Documentary, *Valuable Venom*, June 2024

Saratoga Arts, *'Til Death; a Cinematic Story of Dying Love*, October 2024

Earth Day Selected Film, Documentary, *Valuable Venom*, April 2024

Schick Gallery Selected Film, Documentary, *Between Two Trees*, January 2024

Golden Acorn Award, Experimental Film, *Fauna*, May 2026

Selected Media Projects

Valuable Venom, 2023, producer, director, editor, cinematographer, camera A operation

Mini Worlds, 2025, producer, macro photographer, photoshop

Between Two Trees, 2023, cinematographer, camera operator, animator

Witness- Dancing to Success, 2026, cinematographer and camera operator

Disability Sustaining Pedagogy, 2026, editor, camera operator

A Croak To Action, 2025, Director, producer, editor, camera operator, cinematographer
